Area

Exam code: 0607

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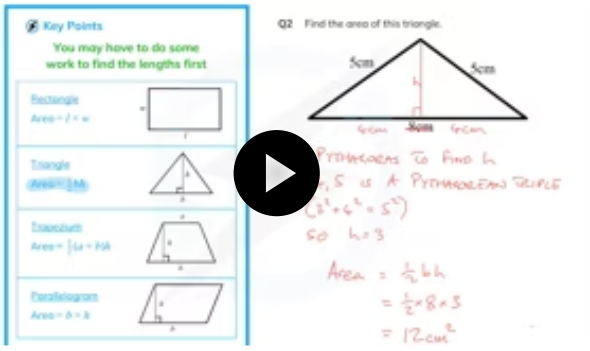

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Area Formulas

What is area?

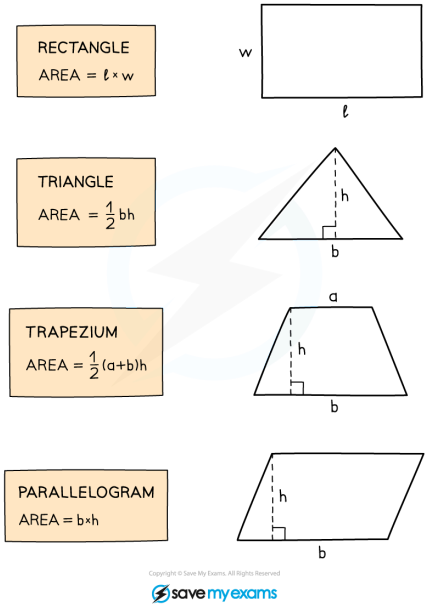
- **Area** is the **amount of space** within the perimeter of a 2D shape
  - For example, the size of a sports field
- Area is calculated using lengths in **two dimensions**
  - **Units of measure** include mm^2, cm^2, m^2 etc

How do I find the area of a shape on a square grid?

- Count the **total number** of **whole squares** inside the shape
  - You can **shade** or **mark** the squares you have counted so far
- Parts of the shape **may not contain whole squares**
  - Pair up **half squares**, or **parts** of squares, to form whole ones
- There will be a **scale** telling you how much area **one square** represents
  - **Multiply** the number of squares you have counted by this value to find the **total area** of the shape

Help me understand

Stuck on something?
Ask questions and get help with exactly what you're revising.
Got it



How do I find the area of a rectangle?

- The area, *A*, of a **rectangle** of length, *l*, and width, *w*, using the formula
  - $A = l \times w$
    - Multiply together the length and the width

How do I find the area of a triangle?

- The area, *A*, of a **triangle** with base, *b*, and length, *l*, can be found using the formula
  - $A = \frac{1}{2}bh$
    - **Multiply** the length of the **base** (*b*) by the **perpendicular height** (*h*)
    - **Halve** the answer
- The formula for the area of a triangle is given to you in the exam
- The **perpendicular height** may not be the length of one of the sides of the triangle

How do I find the area of a trapezium?

- The area, *A*, of a **trapezium** with parallel lengths, *a* and *b*, and perpendicular height, *h*, can be found using the formula
  - $A = \frac{1}{2}(a+b)h$
    - **Add** together the lengths of the **parallel sides**
    - **Multiply** the result by the distance between the parallel sides
    - **Halve** the answer

How do I find the area of a parallelogram?

- You can find the area, A, of a **parallelogram** of length, l, and perpendicular height, h, by using the formula
  - $A = bh$
    - **Multiply** the length of the **base** by the **perpendicular height**
- The **perpendicular height** is **not a length** of the parallelogram
- It is the **distance between** the **base** and its **opposite side**
- You can work the area of a parallelogram out by **splitting the shape** into a rectangle and triangles if you can't remember the formula

Examiner Tips and Tricks

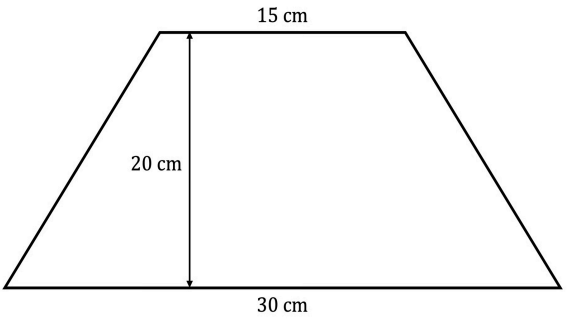
- You may have to do some work to find **missing lengths** first
  - For example, you may need to use **Pythagoras' Theorem** to find a missing length on a triangle
- The **area of a triangle** is given to you in the exam but you will need to remember the other formulae

Worked Example

Calculate the area of the following shapes.

(a)

Find the area of the trapezium using $A = \frac{1}{2}(a+b)h$



Answer:
Remember that a and b are the two parallel sides and h is the perpendicular height

450 cm²

(b)

Find the area of the parallelogram using $A = b \times h$

Answer:

Remember that b is the base and h is the perpendicular height

$$A = 15 \times 12$$

180 cm²

(c)

Find the area of the right-angled triangle using $A = \frac{1}{2}bh$

Answer:

Remember that b is the base and h is the perpendicular height

$$A = \frac{1}{2} \times 8 \times 7$$

28 cm²

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